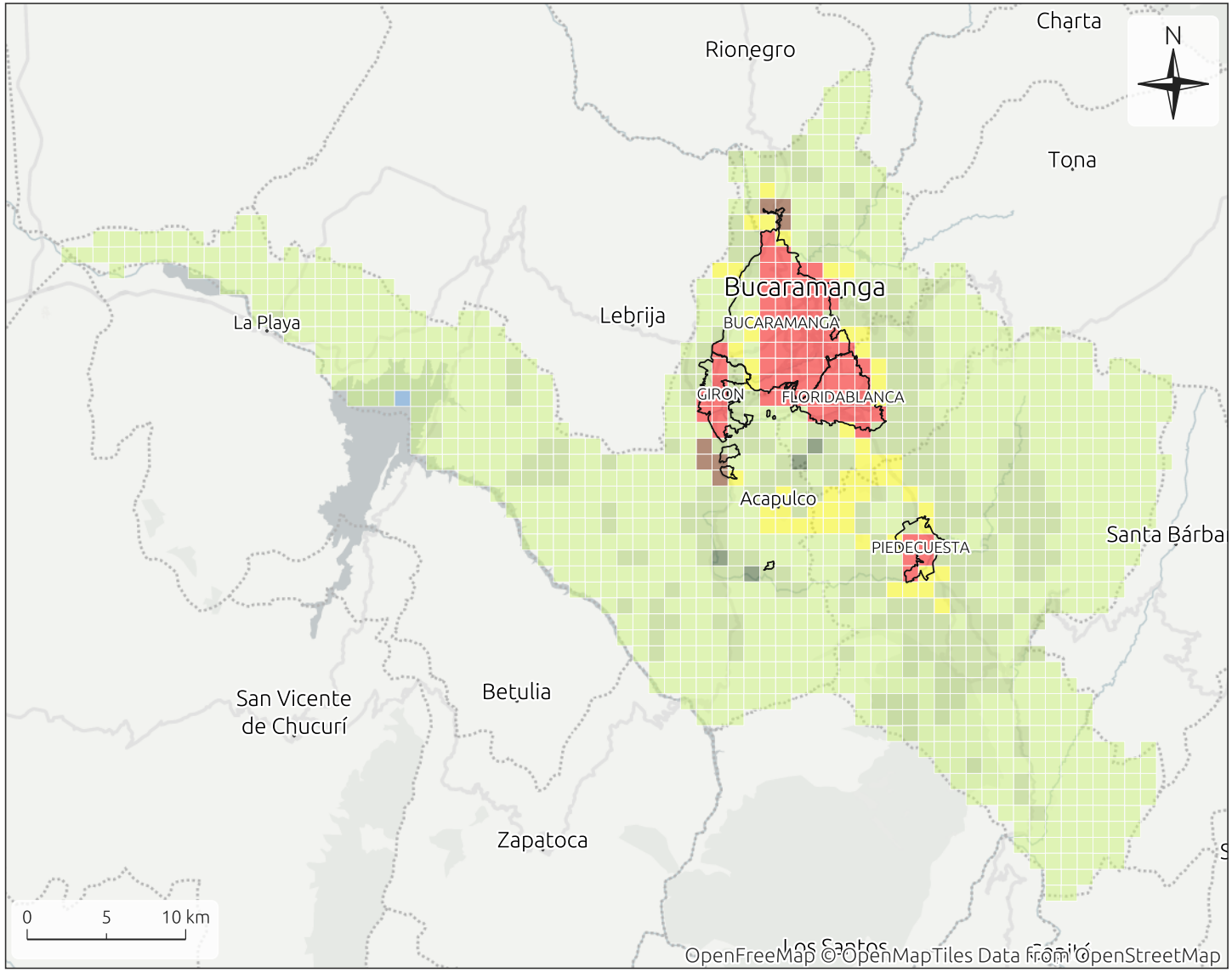
Where does the city end?

Bucaramanga metropolitan area, Colombia: the census degree of urbanisation in 1 km cells and, in black, the legal urban perimeter.
1 in 6 residents (190,000 of 1.1 million) lives in cells whose centre lies outside the urban perimeter.



Degree of urbanisation and people

Perímetro urbano · Urban perimeter

Grado de urbanización · Degree of urbanisation

- 30 · Centro urbano · 896 mil
- 23 · Aglomeración urbana densa · 20 mil
- 21 · Suburbano o periurbano · 55 mil
- 13 · Núcleo rural · 2 mil
- 12 · Rural de baja densidad · 110 mil
- 11 · Rural de muy baja densidad · 18 mil
- 10 · Agua o sin datos

Outside the perimeter

Girón: 61,000 people. Bucaramanga: 54,000. Piedecuesta: 52,000. Floridablanca: 23,000. Of the 190,000, 116,000 live in cells the census already classes as urban or suburban (classes 30, 23 and 21).

Reading it

The degree of urbanisation (UN method, 2020) classes each cell by its density and its neighbours': an urban centre is a group of cells with 1,500 inhabitants per km² or more that adds up to at least 50,000. Each cell counts whole on the side where its centre falls: a cell split by the perimeter isn't shared out.

How it was made: all in RustGIS web (web.rustgis.app), with four scripts. 1 · Data: DANE's 1 km grid and the AMB urban perimeters, queried from their servers.
2 · View: Simplify, Spatial Join (each cell by its centre) and Summary Statistics (people inside and outside). 3–4 · Layouts. Scripts: github.com/jgregoriorincon/30DayMapChallenge-2026

Data: DANE (national statistics office), 1 km statistical grid with the degree of urbanisation (2018 National Population and Housing Census); Bucaramanga Metropolitan Area (AMB), vector basemap (urban zones); accessed 2026-11-07. Colours: GHSL (European Commission). Basemap: OpenFreeMap Positron, © OpenMapTiles, data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). This map and its project: CC BY 4.0.